

Class Notes: Class Cyclostomata

Animal Kingdom • PU-I Biology • Class Notes

General Features

Sucking circular mouth without jaws; elongated, eel-like body. Marine but migrate to fresh water for spawning; die shortly after spawning; larvae metamorphose and return to the ocean.

Life History and Examples

Ectoparasitic on other fishes; respiration by 6-15 pairs of gill slits; body devoid of scales and paired fins; cranium and vertebral column are cartilaginous. Examples: Petromyzon (lamprey), Myxine (hag fish).